

ERS

Suspended and defiant, Lalit Modi prepares to go to war against the BCCI. He's in a corner, but all may not be lost.



ment in the BCCI constitution. Until 2008, Clause 6.2.4 of the Regulations for players, team officials, umpires and administrators, says, "No administrator shall have, directly or indirectly, any commercial interest in the matches and events conducted by the Board." Muthiah's case centres around an amendment made to that clause at the general body meeting held on September 26, 2009, which changed it to read as "no administrator shall have, directly or indirectly, any commercial interest in any of the events of the BCCI, excluding IPL, Champions League and Twenty20", thereby making the ownership of the Chennai Super Kings franchise by Srinivasan legitimate. It is what has turned the BCCI from the Board of Control for Cricket in India to what Muthiah calls, the "Business Control for Cricket in India".

It is what the IPL was all about, on every possible front, not the least the spread of the centralised revenue pool, where deals surrounding media and digital rights, hospitality, merchandising, food and beverages seemed to be unravelling or were being investigated in connection with shell companies, offshore accounts or owners of curious coincidence in the life of Modi. Yet when the fertiliser hit the fan, no one seemed more surprised than the IPL governing council itself, Amin confesses, "We trusted Modi in good faith. I have to admit the IPL governing council could have been more vigilant."

Trust, companionship and loyalty in

Battle Lines

Modi takes guard to bat through the bouncers from the BCCI

BCCI'S CHARGES

1. Irregularities in the process of awarding original franchises
2. Bid rigging
3. Arm-twisting successful bidders
4. IPL Media Rights—awarding a \$80m 'facilitation fee' to MSM
5. Misconduct, actions against the interests of the BCCI

MODI'S DEFENCE

1. Original franchises awarded to leading industrial houses as well as the BCCI's own office-bearer
2. The rights were ratified by the governing council and approved by BCCI's legal department
3. Kochi's happened to be the most contentious bid that needed full disclosure; it cost a Union minister his job
4. The rights were ratified by the governing council and approved by the BCCI's legal department and earned the BCCI \$500 m
5. Charges pertaining to Twitter comments on Kochi franchise will be answered; no proof of other charges